

1. llm-gemini 0.32

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-19T23:46:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/19/llm-gemini-2/#atom-everything>

Release: llm-gemini 0.32 New model gemini-3.5-flash for Gemini 3.5 Flash . See also my notes on Gemini 3.5 Flash , and the pelican I drew using this upgrade to the plugin. Tags: gemini , llm

2. Gemini 3.5 Flash: more expensive, but Google plan to use it for everything

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-19T22:40:25+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/19/gemini-35-flash/#atom-everything>

Today at Google I/O, Google released Gemini 3.5 Flash . This one skipped the -preview modifier and went straight to general availability, and Google appear to be using it for a whole lot of their key products: 3.5 Flash is available today to billions of people globally: For everyone via the Gemini app and AI Mode in Google Search For developers in our agent-first development platform Google Antigravity and Gemini API in Google AI Studio and Android Studio For enterprises in Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform and Gemini Enterprise. As usual with Gemini, the most interesting details are tucked away in the What's new in Gemini 3.5 Flash developer documentation. It mostly has the same set of platform features as the previous Gemini 3.x series, albeit with no computer use . The model ID is gemini-3.5-flash . The knowledge cut-off is January 2025, and it supports 1,048,576 input tokens and 65,536 maximum output tokens. Google are also pushing a new Interactions API , currently in beta, which looks to me like their version of the patterns introduced by OpenAI Responses - in particular server-side history management. The price has gone up Gemini 3.5 Flash is accompanied by a notable price b...

3. datasette-llm-accountant 0.1a4

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-19T20:45:43+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/19/datasette-llm-accountant/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-llm-accountant 0.1a4 Fixed bug tracking chains of responses. Refs datasette-llm#7 Tags: llm , datasette

4. Andrej Karpathy Joined Anthropic

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-19T15:42:38Z

Link: <https://x.com/karpathy/status/2056753169888334312>

Andrej Karpathy, on Twitter/X (XCancel link): Personal update: I've joined Anthropic. I think the next few years at the frontier of LLMs will be especially formative. I am very excited to join the team here and get back to R&D. I remain deeply passionate about education and plan to resume my work on it in time. Karpathy is, to say the least, a star in the AI research field. He co-founded OpenAI in 2015, was director of AI at Tesla (reporting directly to Elon Musk) from 2017-2022, went back to OpenAI in 2023, and then left again in 2024 to start an AI education company named Eureka Labs . He coined the term 'vibe coding' in February last year. ?

5. Define 'Boom'? Please

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-18T17:17:02Z

Link: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/04/21/business/how-apple-became-a-4-trillion-company-under-tim-cook.html?unlocked_article_code=1.jVA.MV8m.0JfUOJOME5WH

While I'm linking to pieces on Apple's CEO transition, here's an annoying tidbit from Tripp Mickle and Karl Russell's piece for The New York Times, under the headline 'Tim Cook Was Very, Very Good at Making Money' (gift link): Even though it has largely missed out on the artificial intelligence boom now lifting the sales of its technology peers, the company's profits and stock value continue to grow. Which peers have had their 'sales lifted' by AI? There's Nvidia (now the most valuable company in the world). But Apple doesn't compete directly with Nvidia. What makes Apple different from its peer companies isn't that the others are profiting from AI

while Apple is not, but rather that Apple, seemingly alone, is not funnelling its free cash flow to Nvidia to build out massive AI datacenters. Apple might wind up missing out on something huge as a result of its decision to stay out of this race. But it's nonsense to say they've already missed out on a boom. To date it's a money pit. ?

6. Ted Turner's Small Apartment Above the Former CNN Center

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-18T16:52:03Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OUIVs58oyPI>

Simultaneously audacious and humble, a combination that epitomizes Ted Turner's entire life . (Shades, too, of Walt Disney's apartment above the fire department at Disneyland.) ?

7. Just shows that nobody cares about debugging the parity flag any more

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260518-00/?p=112334>

Reported incorrectly since the day it was written. The post Just shows that nobody cares about debugging the parity flag any more appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Wi-Wi Is Wireless Time Sync at 1 nanosecond

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 09:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/wi-wi-is-wireless-time-sync-less-than-5ns/>

At NAB, I found a demo of Wi-Wi STAMP , a wireless time synchronization protocol that came out of Japan's NICT . Wi-Wi stands for Wireless 2Way interferometry, and it uses the 900 MHz band for picosecond-level time sync, and mm-level distance accuracy, in a tiny box, currently the size of a smartphone. The system is still in development, but existing prototypes have 20ps of phase synchronization jitter, and time synchronization down to 30ns. The next generation will have time down to 5ns in real-world use.

9. Square root of $x^2 - 1$? 1

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 20 May 2026 00:49:50 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/19/square-root-of-x-squared-minus-one/>

How should we define $\sqrt{z^2 - 1}$? Well, you could square z , subtract 1, and take the square root. What else would you do?! The question turns out to be more subtle than it looks. When x is a non-negative real number, $\sqrt{x}$ is defined to be the non-negative real number whose square is x . When x is [?] The post Square root of $x^2 - 1$ first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Closer look at an identity

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 23:37:31 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/19/closer-look-at-an-identity/>

The previous post derived the identity and said in a footnote that the identity holds at least for $x > 1$ and $y > 1$. That's true, but let's see why the footnote is necessary. Let's have Mathematica plot The plot will be 0 where the identity above holds. The plot is indeed flat for $x > 1$ [?] The post Closer look at an identity first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Approximating Markov's equation

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 12:09:54 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/19/zagiers-equation/>

Markov numbers are integer solutions to $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 3xyz$. The Wikipedia article on Markov numbers mentions that Don Zagier studied Markov numbers by looking the approximating equation $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 3xyz + 4/9$ which is equivalent to $f(x) + f(y) = f(z)$ where $f(t)$ is defined as $\operatorname{arccosh}(3t/2)$. It wasn't clear to me why the [?] The post Approximating Markov's equation first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Pluralistic: There's no such thing as "age verification" (19 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 07:17:09 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/19/shes-dead-of-course/>

Today's links There's no such thing as "age verification": The foreseeable and foreseen consequences of "something must be done"/"there, I've done something." Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Apple Stores exist; Responsible spam; Australia loves Hollywood('s copyright); TCP over Syrian donkey; Icelandic Pirate get funded; Algorithmic cruelty; Trump loves data brokers; Douglas Adams, vindicated; Blog history; Sex names; Flickr's Gamma; "Fuzzy Nation"; The Intercept publishes Snowden docs; Software version of CIA sabotage manual; Who owns covid vaccines? Anal clenching v depression; Web is 10; Danish birds x ringtones; Office-supply X-wing; Nintendo 3DS license sucks is unbelievably bad; Public Interest Internet. Upcoming appearances: Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, Kansas City, LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. There's no such thing as "age verification" (permalink) "Object permanence" is the ability to understand that even if you can't see something, it still exists. Most toddlers ac...

13. The hardware needs of our mail system (as of mid 2026)

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-19T21:21:46Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/OurMailSystemHardware>

In a comment on my entry on universities, email, and the issues of running things in house , I mentioned that our departmental email system has a non-trivial cost in hardware alone to keep going. To better illustrate that, I'll describe all of the servers that our email system currently requires (because it's more than one). Some of these servers exist for historical reasons and may go away at some point, but many of them don't. Currently, we have: A server as our external mail gateway (our DNS MX target). This is separate from other mail servers because it's much simpler to configure and operate this way. A server for the (FOSS) anti-spam and anti-virus software we use (and everyone needs some version of). This could be folded into the mail gateway server (and it was in our recent backup MX , but we weren't sure about the software's resource usage and system impact when we set it up. Keeping it separate also means we can move it to a new OS version for more up to date software without having to worry about any changes in new versions of the mailer that the mail gateway runs. A server for our central mail machine that handles all aspects of email to local addresses, which for vari...

14. Dumb Ways for an Open Source Project to Die

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-19T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/19/dumb-ways-for-an-open-source-project-to-die.html>

Weekend at Bernie?s showed that a good chunk of the most-depended-on open source packages are dead, and there are a lot of different ways for a project to end up that way. The maintainer left Ghost maintainer. The simplest and most common case: last human commit some years back, issues accumulating unanswered, the repo not archived so it doesn?t show up in any filter that would flag it. Usually the maintainer just moved on to other things and the project wasn?t important enough to them to formally hand over or shut down, though the same silence covers everything up to and including the maintainer having died, which neither the registry nor the repo has any way to represent. From outside it?s indistinguishable from a long holiday until enough unanswered issues have piled up to make the silence unambiguous, and the npm utilities at the top of the Bernie?s dead list are mostly this. Corporate orphan. A company built and open-sourced it with a team to run it, then a pivot or a layoff round took the team out and nobody updated the README. The GitHub org persists with the company logo and the last people who had admin rights have left, so often nobody still at the company knows the proj...

15. Book Review: Terrible Worlds: Destinations by Adrian Tchaikovsky ?????

Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 11:34:17 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/book-review-terrible-worlds-destinations-by-adrian-tchakovsky/>

What's better than one Adrian Tchaikovsky novella? Three Adrian Tchaikovsky novellæOr is it

"novellii"? Either way, a delightful triptych of stories on a common theme. On the surface, they're about travelling to a new destination (Space! The Future! For-Copyright-Reasons Not Narnia!) Except, deep down, they're about loneliness. No matter how far or fast we run, no matter where or when we go, ?

16. AI Is Too Expensive

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 15:48:42 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/ai-is-too-expensive/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter. It's \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA , Anthropic and

17. Pythagorean Addition

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/pythagorean-addition>

TL;DR: Instead of labouriously computing $(c = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2})$, we can mentally calculate using the alpha-max plus beta-min algorithm, by estimating $\hat{c} = \max\left(a, 0.9a + 0.5b\right)$ and this will be very close to the actual (c) . This is useful for adding up sources of variance, or figuring out radiuses, or other such things. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

18. Alternatives for the EDIT tool of LLM agents

Source: antirez.com | Published: Tue, 19 May 2026 09:26:03 +0200

Link: <http://antirez.com/news/166>

EDIT: of course this was already done in the past! I had little doubts but people just confirmed me about it on Twitter :) But, keep reading: the CRC32 compromise at the end is an interesting tradeoff, and this is a good discussion to have in general. Right now I'm working to an agent for my DS4 project. Local inference is token-poor, it's a battlefield where optimizations count. I was quite surprised by the fact the EDIT tool everybody is using right now forces the LLM to emit the old version of the text verbatim. This CAS (check and set) mode of operation, where I say EDIT old="foo" new="bar", is needed because there are often colliding edits (the user is editing as well, or checked out a different branch, and so forth) and because the LLM can just hallucinate that a given line had a given content. This means, basically, that just using line numbers is very fragile: to say, change line 22 with new="foobar" is not good. Yet I don't want my local LLM to throw away tokens rewriting the old text each time, also because certain times the old text has a lot of special chars and spaces that the model may get wrong; in this case the tool would fail, forcing the LLM to do the same edit a...

19. RETRACTED: R and the Herd: Why we could be nearer to community immunity than we think

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 14 May 2020 15:27:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/r-and-the-herd/>

Before any non-specialist attempts to write something on COVID-19, we should wonder: are any actual experts already writing on this, and if not, why not. Enough badly informed stuff has already been published by amateurs that before posting we should be certain we are actually being helpful. October 2022 UPDATE: I've removed the rest of this post. Turns out everyone (including me) was wrong, and we didn't understand pandemics of respiratory diseases very well.

20. Mitochondriën op Moederdag

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 10 May 2020 17:15:46 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/mitochondrien/>

Een spontane wetenschapsupdate, omdat het Moederdag is, en speciaal voor iedereen die het nu zonder zijn of haar moeder moet doen. Want, we dragen allemaal letterlijk een beetje onze moeder bij ons! Deze post is dankbaar geïnspireerd door deze Twitter thread van Efra Rivera-Serrano, PhD. Bron: Efra Rivera-Serrano, link Ons DNA is een mix van dat van onze beide

ouders. Maar, in vrijwel al onze cellen leeft een wonderlijk wezentje wat we echt alleen van onze moeder geërfd hebben.

21. COVID-19: het belang van ventileren

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 09 May 2020 09:25:07 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/corona-binnen/>

Het RIVM, het 'Outbreak Management Team' en het kabinet werken samen aan gedegen adviezen.

Uiteindelijk worden dit ook wel de juiste adviezen, al blijft men soms lang aan oude dingen hangen: mensen zonder symptomen zijn niet besmettelijk (oeps, toch wel), maskers hebben geen zin (oeps, ze helpen wel voorkomen dat je andere mensen besmet). Uiteindelijk maakt men de draai wel, maar het kost even. Nu de scholen weer opengaan vroeg ik me af, wat weten we eigenlijk over hoe mensen besmet raken met COVID-19?